

after it started. Today, because of Google, it sits at a mere 4.64% of the global search engine marketshare.

Baidu

This is China's leading search engine, and though it doesn't compete with Google outside of the country, it is still the fourth most popular website globally! Considering it's only used in China, the 5.21% global marketshare is hugely impressive!

Amazon

Amazon is not a search engine competitor of Google, but it does kill a lot of Google's possible revenues because a lot of people who just want to buy products skip Google completely and search for them directly on Amazon.

Others

Other search engines, which hold less than one percent each of the global market share, include Ask.com, AOL and Excite.

Quirks

Privacy remains the biggest concerns among internet users today. Whether it is Google or any other search engine, your Facebook account or even your ISP, you're leaving traces of your searches online. All of them store personal details about you – your IP address, time of search, keywords used for a search, etc. Just remember that when you're marvelling at the personalised search results that Google brings up.

Google has been accused of blatantly targeting ads, not taking a firm stance for net neutrality, has been sued for anti-trust in Europe, provides politically correct search results, etc.

Now whether you like to wear a tin-foil hat when out, or are the type who doesn't really care about privacy, you have to still be aware of the amount of data that the Internet giants collect from you, and given that Google is the biggest one of them all, it's got the most info on you by a mile! Maybe they will never use this information against you, and maybe hackers will never get their hands on it all, but it certainly pays to be informed and aware of what you're signing up for. **d**